

HOUSE RESOLUTION 144

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to urge the United States Department of Justice and the federal government to immediately comply with the law and release the remaining Jeffrey Epstein files in the interest of justice, transparency, and the protection of women and children.

WHEREAS, the sexual exploitation and abuse of minors perpetrated by Jeffrey Epstein represents one of the most disturbing failures of accountability in modern American history; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee has a long and proud tradition of demanding accountability from government, insisting on the rule of law, and standing with victims of crime rather than powerful abusers; and

WHEREAS, the Tennessee General Assembly has repeatedly taken action to strengthen penalties for human trafficking, sexual exploitation, and abuse of children, and has affirmed that protecting vulnerable Tennesseans is a core responsibility of government; and

WHEREAS, survivors, their families, and the American public have called for full transparency regarding individuals who participated in, enabled, or benefited from Epstein's criminal enterprise; and

WHEREAS, federal law and court orders require the timely release of records related to the Epstein investigation, including flight logs, communications, financial records, and the identities of individuals connected to these crimes; and

WHEREAS, the deadline for the release of these files has passed, yet the United States Department of Justice has failed to fully comply, placing the Department in violation of the law and undermining public confidence in our justice system; and

WHEREAS, legislation in Congress to require disclosure of the Epstein files has bipartisan sponsors and bipartisan support, demonstrating that justice, transparency, and accountability transcend party affiliation; and

WHEREAS, Tennesseans expect equal justice under the law and reject a system in which wealth, power, or political connections provide protection from accountability; and

WHEREAS, members of the Tennessee General Assembly—particularly those in the Republican supermajority—frequently emphasize their commitment to protecting women and children, and that commitment must be reflected not only in rhetoric but in action, including demanding transparency in cases of sexual exploitation; and

WHEREAS, continued secrecy surrounding these records deepens harm to survivors, erodes trust in government, and contradicts the values of fairness, decency, and accountability that Tennesseans expect from public institutions; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we hereby urge the United States Department of Justice and the federal government to immediately release all remaining Jeffrey Epstein files, as required by law.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we condemn the failure of the Department of Justice to meet the legal deadline for disclosure and calls for immediate compliance without further delay.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we affirm that transparency and accountability in cases involving sexual exploitation are essential to protecting women and children and to honoring the values long upheld by the State of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we urge Tennessee's congressional delegation to support bipartisan efforts in Congress to compel the release of these records and to ensure justice for survivors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that a certified copy of this resolution be transmitted to the President of the United States, the Attorney General of the United States, the Speaker and the Clerk of the United States House of Representatives, the President and the Secretary of the United States Senate, and each member of Tennessee's Congressional delegation.